

Ἀνώνυμος ὁ Παράδοξογράφος ὁ Φλωρεντινός

The Florentine Paradoxographer on Marvels of Waters

eul_aid: mbc

Period: Ἑλληνιστική [Hellenistic](#)

Dialect: Κοινή [Koine](#)

Domain: Ἱστορία [History](#)

Format: Πεζός [Prose](#)

The Florentine Paradoxographer is an anonymous Greek author believed to have lived in the 1st century BCE. This dating is based on the latest historical events mentioned in the author's only known work. The name is a modern invention, taken from the single 10th-century manuscript in Florence that preserves the text. No details about the author's life, origin, or social background are known.

The author worked within the Hellenistic tradition of paradoxography, a genre dedicated to collecting wondrous and unusual facts. The role was that of a compiler, gathering 35 short accounts of marvels concerning geography, animals, plants, and strange human customs from the works of earlier historians and philosophers. The text is written in straightforward Koine Greek prose.

The work's significance lies in its representation of a popular intellectual tradition. According to modern scholars, such collections acted as a bridge between earlier scientific inquiry and later imperial literature of marvels. As a compilation, it preserves summaries of material from earlier, now-lost authors. Its survival in a single medieval manuscript also provides insight into how such practical Greek texts were copied and transmitted through the centuries.

Works (1)

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